



Money in the digital age

In the same way that the internet revolutionized communication and made globalization possible, digital money, also known as cryptocurrency, promises to change the way people pay for goods and services. Digital money offers a single international “currency” that is not under the control of any financial institution. Instead of notes and coins being printed and minted by individual national banks, computers are used to generate units of digital money.

Breaking free

The money of the future, cryptocurrency, is a medium of financial exchange produced digitally by teams of experts known as “miners.” The miners use specialized hardware to process secure transactions by solving the complex mathematical puzzles that encrypt the electronic currency. Cryptocurrencies can be traded between individuals, and bought and sold through online exchanges. Cryptocurrency can also be used for new methods of exchange such as peer-to-peer lending and crowdfunding.

26%
of Millennials
are expected to
be using digital
currencies
by 2020



Traditional finance

Conventional money unique to a country or region. Also called fiat currency, from the Latin word *fiat* meaning “let it be done,” a term used when making a government decree. Fiat currency is minted by the central banks of individual countries and its value is determined by supply and demand.

